Unit 14 · Past continuous · dates · I was born ...

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

Past continuous says what was in progress at a certain time in the past. We build it with was / were + verb-ing.

Past continuous — что происходило в определённый момент в прошлом. Was / were + глагол с -ing.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Yes	I / he / she / it WAS · we / you / they WERE verb-ing	**I was looking at photos.**	Я смотрел фотографии.
No	wasn't / weren't verb-ing	**He wasn't making a smoothie.**	Он не делал смузи.
Question	Was / Were subject verb-ing?	**Were they going to the theater?**	Они шли в театр?
Wh- question	What were you doing?	**What were you doing at three o'clock?**	Что ты делал в три часа?
Dates	June twenty-second · born ON a date, IN a year	**I was born in 2013.**	Я родился в 2013 году.

When we use it

Say what you were doing: At 3 o'clock I was reading.
Сказать, что делал.

Ask: What were you doing yesterday at five?
Спросить.

Say when someone was born: My dad was born in 1971.
Сказать, когда родился.

REMEMBER

at 3 o'clock yesterday / at that moment / when I came in → past continuous (the action was in progress).

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

In Russian «я смотрел фотографии» shows an action in progress without any special form. In English you need WAS / WERE + -ing (I was looking). Do not forget was / were.

Watch out! We often say...

~~I looking at photos yesterday.~~	**I was looking at photos yesterday.**
~~They was fishing.~~	**They were fishing.**
~~What you were doing?~~	**What were you doing?**
~~I was born at 1971.~~	**I was born in 1971.**

EASY TRICK

Present continuous = now (am / is / are + -ing). Past continuous = then (was / were + -ing). Do not forget was / were!

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 At 3 o'clock I ___ at photos. (looked / was looking)

2 They ___ fishing. (was / were)

3 He ___ making a smoothie. (wasn't / weren't)

4 ___ you going to the theater? (Was / Were)

5 I was born ___ 1971. (in / on)

6 I was born ___ July 9th. (in / on)

Answers: 1 was looking · 2 were · 3 wasn't · 4 Were · 5 in · 6 on